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www.linkedin.com/in/harpersean
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www.tss-radio.com (Company)
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Top Skills

Venture Capital
Strategy
Investments

Sean Harper

CEO and Founder of Kin
Twin Lakes, Wisconsin, United States

Summary

Former management consultant, current multi-time tech company founder and angel investor. My focus is on financial services technology. Banks, insurance companies, etc are basically software companies in disguise, but are often not particularly good at software development, which creates an opportunity for people with our skill set.

Experience

Kin Insurance

CEO and Co Founder

September 2016 - Present (9 years 11 months)

At Kin we are fixing the homeowners insurance industry.

Accion USA

Board Member

October 2014 - October 2019 (5 years 1 month)

Chicago

Mainly I help Accion USA on matters of technology, distribution and strategy.

2Checkout

Chief Product Officer

July 2014 - November 2015 (1 year 5 months)

Chicago, IL

2checkout makes it easy for merchants outside the US to accept electronic payments from customers all over the world. Our specialty is in cross-border transactions, which many payments providers do not handle well. 2checkout has been around since the 2000s, but recently raised significant outside capital, hired a new management team and opened an office in Chicago.

Groupon

Director of Breadcrumb Payments (by Groupon)

March 2012 - July 2014 (2 years 5 months)

Chicago and San Francisco

In early 2012 Groupon purchased FeeFighters. Now I run Groupon/
Breadcrumb Payments.

Breadcrumb Payments comes with Breadcrumb's mobile payments app and both of our award-winning tablet-based point of sale systems. Breadcrumb Payments are reliable, secure, easy to sign up for and very low cost. Most importantly, however, we are the only payments company that helps businesses attract and retain more customers.

<http://techcrunch.com/2013/05/14/groupon-rebrands-its-mobile-payments-business-as-breadcrumb-adds-ipad-merchant-app-and-a-5k-no-fee-sweetener-to-bring-on-new-users/>

<http://www.chicagobusiness.com/article/20120920/NEWS08/120919712/the-story-behind-groupons-credit-card-processing-business#ixzz2K3rOU1aE>

I am a frequent speaker on payments innovation, in particular the intersection of payments and marketing/crm.

3/3/2013 - Prepaid Expo - <http://www.iirusa.com/upload/wysiwyg/All%20Speaker%20Biographies.pdf>

4/16/2013 - Local Search Association - <http://www.localsearchassociation.org/main/speakers2013/26.aspx>

4/30/2013 - Electronic Transactions Association - <http://www2.electran.org/am13/speaker-sean-harper/>

6/3/2013 - Mobile Banking and Commerce Summit - <http://www.americanbanker.com/authors/sean-harper-1735.html?csite=mobile>

6/24/2013 - Mobile Commerce World - <http://www.mcommworld.com/sanfrancisco/conference/keynote-speakers.php>

10/23/2013 - NRA Restaurant Innovation Summit http://www.restaurant.org/Events-Networking/Events/Restaurant_Innovation_Summit/Agenda

FeeFighters.com

Founder / CEO

2009 - March 2012 (3 years)

Chicago

Josh Krall and I started Feefighters in 2009 when we were in grad school. We raised \$1.6M from angels and institutions (<http://www.crunchbase.com/company/transparent-financial-services>) and sold the business at a profit to Groupon in 2012 (goo.gl/hHCs2h).

The technology that we developed at FeeFighters become Groupon Payments (<https://breadcrumb.groupon.com/payments>) which was launched shortly after the acquisition.

FeeFighters was started because of my frustration as a business owner with the credit card processing options that were available at the time -- all of which were lousy.

Initially we solved that problem by building a comparison engine to accurately compare each of the processing options (like Kayak, but for credit card processing).

Shortly after raising money, however, we decided none of the existing providers was good enough and developed from scratch our own modern payments processor (similar to stripe or square). After launching that technology we were almost immediately acquired by Groupon.

Here are some links about FeeFighters:

<http://www.finovate.com/fall11vid/feefighters.html>

<http://tech.co/feefighters-hottest-early-stage-startup-chicago-2011-04>

<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Feefighters>

<http://images.businessweek.com/slideshows/20110211/america-s-most-promising-startups#slide8>

goo.gl/cBFAoT

Boston Consulting Group

Consultant

September 2006 - March 2010 (3 years 7 months)

At BCG I primarily advise large financial institutions on issues of strategy and operations.

TSS-Radio

Co-Founder

December 2004 - January 2010 (5 years 2 months)

In late 2004 I co-founded this company with an old friend. TSS-Radio is a leading online retailer of SIRIUS satellite radios and accessories, known for wide selection and excellent service.

TSS-Radio was #94 in the Inc500 in 2009.

Longworth Venture Partners

Associate

January 2005 - May 2006 (1 year 5 months)

Investing in Software, Internet and Media. Completed deals - Sermo and Innovectra.

Longworth typically leads an investment in a company's first or second round of funding. We invest \$1-3 million in that first round and, if appropriate, recruit another top-tier investor to syndicate additional capital. We reserve sufficient funds to support your company in future financings.

Boston Consulting Group

Associate

2003 - 2005 (2 years)

At BCG I worked mainly in Financial Services and Retail.

The Boston Consulting Group is an international strategy and general management consulting firm whose mission is to help leading corporations create and sustain competitive advantage. As a truly international firm, our strong global presence offers clients and employees a wealth of cross-cultural experience.

Education

The University of Chicago - Booth School of Business

MBA, Entrepreneurship/Entrepreneurial Studies · (2007 - 2009)

University of Chicago

AB, Economics · (1999 - 2003)

Marquette University High School

high school · (1995 - 1999)